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Software Developer

UK Health Security Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Wednesday 5th August 2026



Reference number

471952

Salary

£46,310 - £52,113

per annum, pro rata

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Other

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Colindale

About the job

Job summary

We are looking for a Developer to work as part of the Data & Surveillance Services Division of the Digital & Data Directorate, UKHSA. You will be part of

a team responsible for developing and supporting systems that support the organisation's clinical and scientific teams in the delivery of our Health Protection capabilities.

Digital & Data

The UKHSA Digital & Data Directorate provides strategic leadership and oversight for developing and managing a common and bespoke suite of performant, modern, secure, data and analytical tools, services, platforms and applications, ensuring access to high quality data and analytics services, internally and externally.

Data & Surveillance Services

Based within the Digital & Data Directorate, the Data and Surveillance Services Division works across the organisation and with external partners to lead the design, development, maintenance and delivery of system which are accessible, interoperable and which improving health security outcomes. The Division supports the UKHSA's laboratory workflow and surveillance functions and is responsible for its central bioinformatics service which delivers whole genome sequencing for pathogens of concern.

Working for your organisation

We pride ourselves as being an employer of choice, where Everyone Matters promoting equality of opportunity to actively encourage applications from everyone, including groups currently underrepresented in our workforce.

UKHSA ethos is to be an inclusive organisation for all our staff and stakeholders. To create, nurture and sustain an inclusive culture, where differences drive innovative solutions to meet the needs of our workforce and wider communities. We do this through celebrating and protecting differences by removing barriers and promoting equity and equality of opportunity for all.

Please visit our careers site for more information <https://gov.uk/ukhsa/careers>

Job description

Develop & manage technical aspects of the software systems and services to meet user needs and integrate with databases and other repositories.

Design solutions and services with security controls embedded, specifically engineered with mitigation of security threats as a core feature.

Ensure software is flexibly developed so that it can be variably hosted on a range of computational environments including UKHSA's servers, high performance computer infrastructure, and commercial cloud providers such as Amazon or Azure.

Identify, diagnose and investigate technical problems, methodically applying appropriate tests and gathering sufficient information to enable a solution.

Use the agreed specifications to design, code, test and document programs or scripts of medium-to-high complexity, using the right standards and tools. Ensure clean, secure and well-tested code.

Write database code to modern standards including the advanced SQL and Oracle PL/SQL scripts that enable optimised complex processing of data within and between information systems and for egress of data from these systems for onward use.

Ensure software code which is created, developed and maintained by the team is managed appropriately through the implementation of an appropriate source code repository which is aligned to the UKHSA technology strategy of UKHSA.

Competently apply a modern standards approach in all aspects of design and development, producing detailed designs and effectively documenting all work using required standards, methods and tools, including prototyping tools.

Develop & support databases and software applications used to support data collection, analysis and dissemination. This will include a drive towards automation and more resilient, reliable infrastructure.

Coordinate with colleagues in the development of code using appropriate languages, established modern software engineering principles and design patterns, including the development of prototypes.

Select and implement modern RAD (rapid application development) tools for prototyping and where appropriate, for implementation of minimal viable products.

Contribute to the creation of standards and policies relating to these.

Be responsible for ensuring that system availability, performance and data flow is monitored and to seek ways to make continuous improvements to

improve resilience, data quality and to shape improvements in service delivery including improvements to development processes.

Use software engineering practices that ensure compliance with information security and quality policies and procedures, designing solutions and services with security controls embedded, specifically engineered with mitigation of security threats as a core feature.

Work with Technology group colleagues to coordinate and implement multidisciplinary approaches to data pipeline production and application/database hosting on various platforms, where necessary migrating current software solutions to new architectures.

Select appropriate system designs characterised by medium levels of risk, impact, and business or technical complexity.

Collaborate with colleagues to ensure that current best practice for software specification, development, testing and implementation is followed across the software development activities of the Division.

Manage testing of software applications and databases to ensure that development is to agreed specifications, uses appropriate tools and adheres to commercial and UKHSA standards.

Identify, locate and fix faults in systems both during development and after deployment to production environments including working with infrastructure colleagues to resolve issues that could cause loss of service. You will prioritise your work to ensure that organisation key services are kept available.

Undertake training as required by UKHSA or for the specific requirements of projects and undertake any other duties commensurate with your grade.

Please note, the above list is not exhaustive.

Person specification

Essential Criteria

Bachelor's degree (or higher) in Computer Science, Software Engineering, Information Technology, Computer Engineering, or a closely related discipline. Alternatively, significant professional experience in software development, demonstrating equivalent knowledge and skills gained through industry practice.

Experience of designing, developing and delivering large and complex software solutions

Proven ability to write high quality software documentation and implementation of quality standards for coding among a team.

Expert knowledge/experience of Microsoft development technologies including, Visual Studio .Net.

Experience of implementing a containerised approach to code deployment across development teams and a moving from on premise to cloud native development.

Experience of SQL, the MS SQL Server suite, Transact-SQL

Proven skills in at least one object-oriented programming language, such as C#, and intermediate knowledge of Python

Knowledge of deploying code to enterprise architectures and the cloud, including the use of containers. Experience of OpenShift and/or Kubernetes

Experience of Internet Information Services (IIS), web application deployment, administration and security

Experience of the use of Git, GitHub actions and associated tools for version control, integration, deployment or another industry standard version control and CI/CD tools.

An understanding of and commitment to equality of opportunity and good working relationships, both in terms of day-to-day working practices, but also in relation to management systems

An understanding of software Change Control practices

Desirable Criteria

Knowledge of Agile software development methodologies

Previous work with Azure AD

Experience of JIRA and Confluence

Oracle PL/SQL development

Experience of software used for pipeline development

Proven skills in developing and modifying code used for data analysis and the production of reports in SQL Server Reporting Services, Power BI and other reporting tools

Experience of PowerShell

Experience of working in healthcare or biomedical sciences

Experience in industry or academia of delivering multi-disciplinary projects within deadlines

Experience of working on large software projects

Knowledge of PostgreSQL/MSSQL/MariaDB would be a distinct advantage as well as the ability to work across a range of technologies

Knowledge of NoSQL DBs, e.g., MongoDB, Cosmos DB and Elastic

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £46,310, UK Health Security Agency contributes £13,416 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity

A [Civil Service pension](#) with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using Success Profiles and will assess your Behaviours, Ability, Experience, Technical skills.

Stage 1: Application & Sift

You will be required to complete an application form. You will be assessed on the listed 12 essential criteria, and this will be in the form of a:

Application form (Employer/ Activity history section on the application)
1500 word supporting statement.

This should outline how you consider your skills, experience and knowledge provide evidence of your suitability for the role, with reference to the essential criteria.

You will receive a joint score for your application form and statement. (The application form is the kind of information you would put into your C.V please be advised you will not be able to upload your CV. Please complete the application form in as much detail as possible). Please do not email us your CV.

Longlisting:

In the event of a large number of applications we will longlist into 3 piles of:

1. Meets all essential criteria
2. Meets some essential criteria
3. Meets no essential criteria

If used, the pile Meets all essential criteria will proceed to shortlisting.

Shortlisting:

In the event of a large number of applications we may conduct an initial sift, on the lead criteria of:

Experience of designing, developing and delivering large and complex software solutions

Proven skills in at least one object-oriented programming language, such as C#, and intermediate knowledge of Python

Experience of SQL, the MS SQL Server suite, Transact-SQL

Desirable criteria may be used in the event of a large number of applications or large amount of successful candidates.

If you are successful at this stage, you will progress to interview & assessment.

Feedback will not be provided at this stage.

Stage 2: Interview

Success profiles [Success Profiles - GOV.UK](#)

You will be invited to a single face to face interview at 61 Colindale Avenue, Colindale London NW9 5EQ

If face to face interviews are planned, in exceptional circumstances, we may be able to offer a remote interview.

Behaviours, Ability, Experience and Technical skills will be tested at interview.

Ability and Experience will be assessed through a series of questions.

You will be required to complete a 45 minute technical skills assessment designed to evaluate your proficiency in C# development, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) principles, and backend SQL development.

The Behaviours tested during the interview stage will be:

- Making Effective Decisions

- Communication and Influencing

- Working Together

- Managing a Quality Service (Lead Behaviour)

Interview dates are to be confirmed.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Qualifications and Registrations

For roles where specific qualifications or registrations are required, successful applicants will be asked to provide appropriate evidence. Employment cannot commence until satisfactory documentation has been received and verified.

Location

This role is being offered as hybrid working based at our Scientific Campus in Colindale. We offer great flexible working opportunities at UKHSA and operate using a hybrid working model where business needs allow. This provides us with greater flexibility about how and where we work, to get the best from our workforce. As a hybrid worker, you will be expected to spend a minimum of 60% of your contractual working hours (approximately 3 days a week pro rata, (averaged over a month) working at our campus.

Based at our scientific campus, you will be required to have a minimum of a Counter Terrorism Check security vetting check as a minimum. For meaningful National Security Vetting checks to be carried out individuals need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time. You should normally have been resident in the United Kingdom for the last 3 years as the role requires Counter Terrorism Check (CTC) clearance. In exceptional circumstances UK residency less than the outlined periods may not necessarily bar you from gaining national security vetting and applicants should contact the Vacancy Holder/Recruiting Manager listed in the advert for further advice.

Security Clearance Level Requirement

Successful candidates must pass a standard enhanced disclosure and barring security check before they can be appointed.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is Counter-Terrorist Check .

Eligibility Criteria

Open to all external applicants (anyone) from outside the Civil Service (including internal applicants).

Future location

UKHSA is investing in a new state-of-the-art National Biosecurity Centre in Harlow, Essex, which will eventually bring together teams currently based at Canary Wharf, Colindale and Porton Down. For more details, please see: [Huge biosecurity centre investment to boost pandemic protection - GOV.UK](#)

The new facilities will start becoming operational in the mid-2030s, with full completion by 2038. Staff will move in phases as facilities become available. If you're appointed to a role currently based at Canary Wharf, Colindale or Porton Down, please note that we'll continue investing in these sites for the next decade. As we get closer to the transition, we'll provide full information about relocation support available to staff

Reasonable Adjustments

The Civil Service is committed to making sure that our selection methods are fair to everyone. To help you during the recruitment process, we will consider any reasonable adjustments that could help you. An adjustment is a change to the recruitment process or an adjustment at work. This is separate to the Disability Confident Scheme. If you need an adjustment to be made at any point during the recruitment process you should contact the recruitment team in confidence as soon as possible to discuss your needs.

You can find out more information about reasonable adjustments across the Civil Service here: [Reasonable Adjustments , Civil Service Careers](#)

International Police check

If you have spent more than 6 months abroad over the last 3 years you may need an International Police Check. This would not necessarily have to be in a single block, and it could be time accrued over that period.

Internal Fraud Check

If successful for this role as one aspect of pre-employment screening, applicant's personal details – name, national insurance number and date of birth - will be checked against the Cabinet Office Internal Fraud Hub, and anyone included on the database will be refused employment unless they can show exceptional circumstances. Currently this is only for external candidates to the Civil Service

Careers website

Please visit our careers site for more information [UKHSA Hub , Civil Service Careers](#)

Salary Information

If you are successful at interview, and are moving from another government department, NHS, or Local Authority, the relevant starting salary principles for level transfers or promotions will apply. Otherwise, roles are offered at the pay scale minimum for the grade, but in exceptional circumstances there may be flexibility if you are able to demonstrate you are already in receipt of an existing, higher salary. Pay increases are through the relevant annual pay award for the role and terms.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [counter-terrorist check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Charlene Gwekwerere

Email : charlene.gwekwerere@ukhsa.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : recruitment@ukhsa.gov.uk

Further information

The law requires that selection for appointment to the Civil Service is on merit on the basis of fair and open competition as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact UKHSA Public Accountability Unit via email: Complaints@ukhsa.gov.uk If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission: Visit the Civil Service Commission website [here](http://www.civilservice.com).

<http://www.healthjobsuk.com/vacancy/8146511>

Civil Service
Commission

